MONTHLY UPDATE

Sudan: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · CAPACITY

Summary of the month

The central bank revoked a mobile-payment and switching licence on 28 September. A first bank went live on the national digital identity link on 26 September. The finance ministry signed a text-message services agreement with a mobile operator for the electronic collection system and announced launch steps for the Itzan national budget system. The dominant mobile payment application failed on 2 September alongside other digital banking platforms.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

A banker's review published on 21 September finds no implementation programmes, budgets or indicators attached to the central bank's 2026-2030 strategic plan. The plan carries 150 initiatives, and its digital axis commits to a banking disaster-recovery centre, a wider data-centre network and a hybrid cloud project.

Standards

The White Nile branch of the standards body launched electronic collection of standards and metrology fees, reported on 15 September, issuing an electronic receipt at payment. No count of branches live is published.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The national operators of Djibouti, Ethiopia and Sudan presented the Horizon Fiber corridor to carriers and equipment vendors at a pre-commercialisation meeting in Addis Ababa on 7 September 2026, ahead of deployment.

DPI

Data Exchange

The first service the repository holds that names agency-to-agency links went live. A needs-disclosure service on the national platform lets an investor complete the step digitally, and wires the industry, transport, agriculture and customs bodies to each other electronically. The links are asserted in the launch announcement and nothing else: no data-sharing instrument, service volume or processing time is published.

Digital Identity and CRVS

A first bank went live on the national digital identity link on 26 September 2026, letting customers inside and outside the country update their data through its digital channels; the remaining banks are to join one by one.

The prime minister of the TASIS-backed administration announced plans on 11 October 2026 for a national smart identity card for banking, judicial and administrative transactions in territory outside the Port Sudan authorities' control. No issuer, technology or date is stated, and the administration's population figures are unverified.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The payment outages ran on. Intermittent failures of the dominant banking app and another e-payment service pushed traders back to cash and prompted a social-media campaign to withdraw funds and switch banks. The finance ministry signed a framework with 11 companies to supply portable electronic collection devices to state institutions.

The gap between cash and app money drew an order from the other side of the war. The RSF commander told traders in areas his forces hold to charge one price whether customers pay in cash or through banking applications such as Bankak, ending the premium on app payments. In Khartoum, meanwhile, converting app balances into banknotes cost 5 per cent at most shops and up to 10 per cent at some, amid a cash shortage and restricted banking applications.

The central bank revoked Sudan Pay Digital's mobile-payment and switching licence on 28 September by Administrative Decision No. 65 of 2026, citing the 2026 banking act and the 2020 and 2013 payment regulations and giving no reason; it is the second switch licence withdrawn since July. On 27 September the finance ministry signed an agreement with MTN Sudan for text-message services on its electronic collection system, so that the operator's subscribers can use the system and follow their transactions. A second operator, Zain, signed a text-message services agreement for the state collection system on 4 October, letting its subscribers use the system and follow their transactions. A bank launched a USSD banking service with a mobile operator, needing neither internet nor a smartphone and aimed at humanitarian payments. The finance ministry signed a contract with Sudani on 8 October 2026 for text-message services supporting the system, the third such agreement with a mobile operator. Disruptions in the days before 9 October 2026 again left the application's customers unable to reach or transfer their money, amid cash and fuel shortages; the bank apologised. The bank launched a USSD transfer service on one mobile operator's SIMs, reported 10 October 2026, so customers can transact without a smartphone or internet.

Registries

Company commercial registration was added to the national e-government platform, with two services for the legal profession, reported on 1 October. It is the first movement on the register since administrative work in Port Sudan was suspended in December 2025; no count of registrations made online is published. A survivors' fund opened a tender for a secure, offline-capable digital victims' registry, built with a national organisation in an 18-month project from 1 November 2026, with about 500 survivors to be documented first and hosting outside the country.

Sectoral management information systems

The civil-service platform's purpose was argued rather than measured. A commentary holds that its value lies in removing manipulation and favouritism from civil-service appointments rather than in the digitisation itself. It is an opinion piece, and the repository holds no appointment volume, grievance count or audit against which the claim could be tested — which is the same gap the platform's own launch left. The zakat chamber signed a contract with a national company to complete an integrated resource-planning system linking its banking, staff and financial systems, a project stopped during the war. The chamber says the new platform will unify all of its databases.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Identity services are being rebuilt in the capital. The police reopened the Omdurman and Bahri service complexes, with transactions rising from 206,362 in 2025 to 522,225 in 2026, and set out a plan to issue passports, ID cards and licences from home, with cash abolished at the counters through seven banks.

The education ministry launched online application and electronic fee payment for the Sudan School Certificate on 29 September, with the certificate collectable inside or outside the country; no uptake figure is published. The animal resources ministry launched an official website for producers, breeders and investors on 7 September, and a government platform was put before the national economic management committee in a meeting on stabilising the exchange rate; what the platform does and who runs it are not stated.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Khartoum State put its standard systems back into operation, connected a government fibre network to 36 state units and signed six partnership memoranda.

Capacity

Training and skills

The higher education council's president approved by decision 138 of 2026 a regulation giving e-learning and blended learning in higher-education institutions a legal basis, in force from signature on 12 September.

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